

ART 323: COLOR THEORY COURSE PACK



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Art 323: Color Theory Course Pack

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Licensing

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Materials and Resources

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1.1: Required Texts and Supplies

Textbooks

There is one textbook used as resources for this class along with this coursepack. It is available for free through the Cosumnes River College library.

Hornung, David. *Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers* ([opens in new window](#)). 2nd ed. Laurence King Publishing, 2002.

Supplies

Acrylic Paint

Note: Do not buy heavy bodied paint unless you can't get the color in medium bodied paint. It has too much texture for design projects. I recommend purchasing large economy tubes.

- Reds:
 - Cadmium red medium – do not get the hue version, it is too transparent
 - Alizarine crimson
- Yellows:
 - Cadmium yellow medium - do not get the hue version, it is too transparent
 - Yellow ochre
- Blues:
 - Pthalo blue
 - Ultramarine blue
- Green:
 - Pthalo green
- Brown:
 - Burnt umber
 - Burnt sienna
- Black:
 - Mars black – other blacks are fine
- White:
 - Titanium white (large size) - you may need another large tube in the middle of the semester
- Satin medium & varnish – Do not get gel, liquid is best. 1 pint recommended

Additional Materials:

- Two flat watercolor brushes ½" and 1"
- One round watercolor brush #6
- Mixing Palette 12" x 16" paper palette
- Palette knife for mixing paint – trowel type best
- Large plastic water container: Tall enough for all brushes to stand
- Roll of paper towels
- Baby wipes for wiping hands, tables, and brushes
- Roll ¾" Painter's Tape
- Large glue stick
- Xacto Knife
- HB (#2) Pencil
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Staedtler Mars plastic eraser
- Pigma Micron Pen black .45 mm
- Ruler 18" – metal is best
- Viewer See Make a Viewer, D2L Handouts & Information link

- Blick Pocket Color Mixing Guide
- Container for supplies
- Strathmore Bristol Board Pad (vellum) 14" x 17"
- Canson Mixed Media Pad (60 sheets) 9" x 12"
- Two sheets Canson Presentation Board, Pearl (tan) color, 16" x 20"
- Drawing Board larger than 14" x 17", no larger than 18" x 18"
- Portfolio (folder for work presentation) 17" x 22" - must be able to fit in the locker

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1.2: Color Terms

Introduction

The following terms will be used throughout the course in your readings and assignments.

- **Achromatic Grays:** Grays without hue or saturation, only value. Achromatic means “without color”.
- **Additive Color:** Color seen as light. Additive primaries are red, green, and blue. When they are combined the result is white light.
- **Analogous:** Hues are next to each other on the spectrum and the color wheel.
- **Bridge Tones:** Tones that provide a transition between two different colors. This is achieved by gradually mixing the second color with the first.
- **Color Structure:** Three factors influence the appearance of color: hue, value, and saturation.
- **Chromatic Darks:** Dark chromatic grays that have discernible temperature and hue.
- **Chromatic Grays:** Chromatic grays have relatively low saturation, but still have discernible hue and temperature.
- **Color Harmony:** The character of the interrelations in groups of colors. Harmonious colors are highly unified. Inharmonious or discordant colors are in disagreement with each other.
- **Color Interaction:** Quality of a color depends upon its context. An identical color can appear different from a different context to another.
- **Color Temperature:** Division of warm and cool zones on the color wheel.
 - **Warm colors:** Red-violet, red, orange, yellow, yellow-green.
 - **Cool colors:** Violet, blue-violet, blue, blue-green, green.
- **Color Wheel:** Circular graphic display of the spectrum, usually in 12 major hues that include primary, secondary and tertiary colors.
- **CMYK:** Colors used in four color printing: cyan, magenta, yellow and black.
- **Complementary Hues:** Complements are any two hues that are directly opposite each other on a color wheel. When complements are mixed, the resulting color is darker and duller than both of the two parent colors.
- **Earth Tone Primary:** A triad of earth tones: burnt sienna, yellow ochre, and Payne’s gray (a blue gray mixture of ultramarine blue & black).
- **Gamut:** A range of hues available to a particular color mode, such as the visible spectrum, RGB (computer screen) and CMYK (four color printing).
- **Grayscale:** Representation of the value continuum broken down into distinct and evenly progressing achromatic grays.
- **High Key:** Values in a color image are predominantly light.
- **Hue:** One of three structural factors of color (along with value and saturation). The name given to a color to describe its location on the color spectrum.
- **Keyed:** Color groupings are keyed when they are brought together in either hue, value, saturation, or combinations thereof.
- **Low Key:** Values are “keyed” predominantly dark in an image.
- **Luminosity:** Light reflected from a surface. The lighter the color the more luminous it is.
- **Median Transparency:** An illusion of transparency created by overlapping two colors diverse in value. The overlapping area of the two colors appears to be an equal blend of the two adjacent colors.
- **Monochromatic:** Color schemes that are limited to one hue and variations thereof. There may a broad range of value and saturation levels.
- **Muted Colors:** Muted colors are softer than prismatic colors, but still retain a sense of hue identity.
- **Optical mixing:** Small color fragments next to each other are fused into seamless transitions by the eye. Used in tapestry, mosaic, four color printing and Pointillism (see artist Georges Seurat).
- **Primary colors:** Red, yellow, blue - cannot be obtained by mixing.
- **Primary triad:** Primary red, yellow and blue triangle on the color wheel. In theory, all colors can be mixed from the three primary colors.
- **RGB:** Red, green, blue. Colors used in additive or lighting color.
- **Saturation:** The relative purity of hue in a color. Highly saturated colors are vivid and rich in hue. Low saturation colors are dull and show a weak hue presence. Three levels of saturation: prismatic color, muted color and chromatic gray.
- **Secondary (triad) colors:** Green, orange and violet. Each of these colors are created by mixing two primary colors.
- **Shade:** The result of mixing any color with black.

- **Simultaneous Contrast:** Simultaneous contrast is the optical effect that two neighboring colors have upon each other as their afterimages interact along a shared border. This is most evident when highly saturated exact complements are placed side by side.
- **Spectrum:** A phenomenon of light that can be seen in a rainbow or through a prism. The spectrum contains the full range of hues present in sunlight.
- **Subtractive color:** Color from reflected light, rather than direct light. Subtractive color primaries are red, yellow and blue which, produce a dark dull tone when intermixed.
- **Tertiary colors:** Also called “intermediate colors are yellow-orange, red-orange, blue-green, yellow-green, blue-violet and red-violet. They are produced by mixing one primary color with one secondary color.
- **Tint:** A tint results when any color is mixed with white.
- **Tones:** A generic term that refers to any color but a prismatic color. All muted colors and chromatic grays are tones, as are all tints and shades.
- **Value:** The relative quality of lightness or darkness in a color. It is the only structural factor visible in achromatic images, as in black and white photography. Value means luminosity.

Works Cited

Hornung, David. *Color : A Workshop for Artists and Designers*. 2nd ed. London: Laurence King, 2012.

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1.3: Color Mixing Tips

Mixed Black / Gray:

Mix burnt umber and ultramarine blue until it appears to be black. Start with the brown and gradually add the blue until your paint pile that appears to be black. Scrape off a small amount of the paint with your palette knife and gradually add a little white. If it appears to be blue or brown, the balance between the two colors is not correct. Continue testing the larger dark pile until it appears gray in the small sample. Do not pollute the large white or mixed black pile on your palette. Create a large middle gray pile. You will have three piles of paint: mixed black, mixed middle gray and white. Mix gradations on other areas of the palette - this is why you need a large palette. Mixing thalo green and alizarine crimson follow the same procedure.

Mixing Color:

- Primary red = cadmium red
- Primary blue = ultramarine + small touch of phthalo blue
- Primary yellow = cadmium yellow
- Purple = alizarine crimson + ultramarine blue
- Orange = cadmium red + cadmium yellow
- Green = cadmium yellow + phthalo blue - do not use phthalo green
- Payne's gray = black + a tiny amount of ultramarine blue

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1.4: Full Color Palette Layout

Creating your Palette

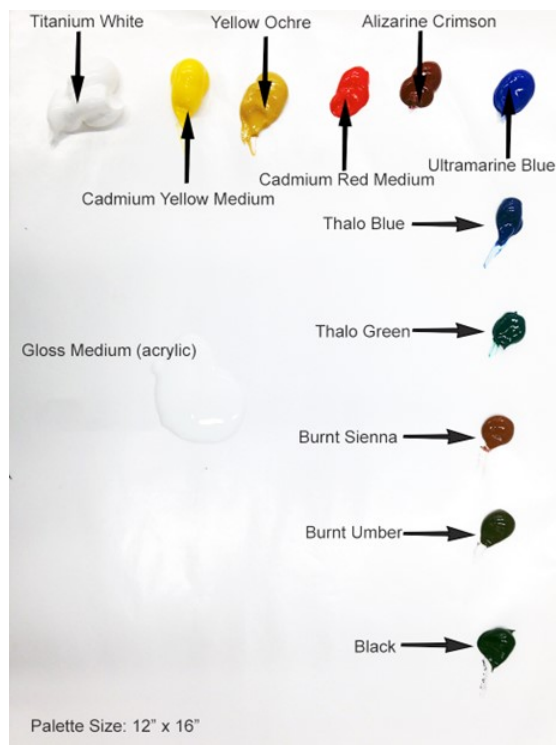
Place your colors across the top and down the right side of a 12 inch by 16 inch palette in the shape of a number seven. The top row should be in the following order:

1. Titanium White
2. Cadmium Yellow Medium
3. Yellow Ochre
4. Cadmium Red Medium
5. Alizarine Crimson
6. Ultramarine Blue

Below the Ultramarine Blue and down the right side, the colors should be in the following order:

1. Thalo Blue
2. Thalo Green
3. Burnt Sienna
4. Burnt Umber
5. Black

In the middle of your seven shape, place Gloss Medium (acrylic)



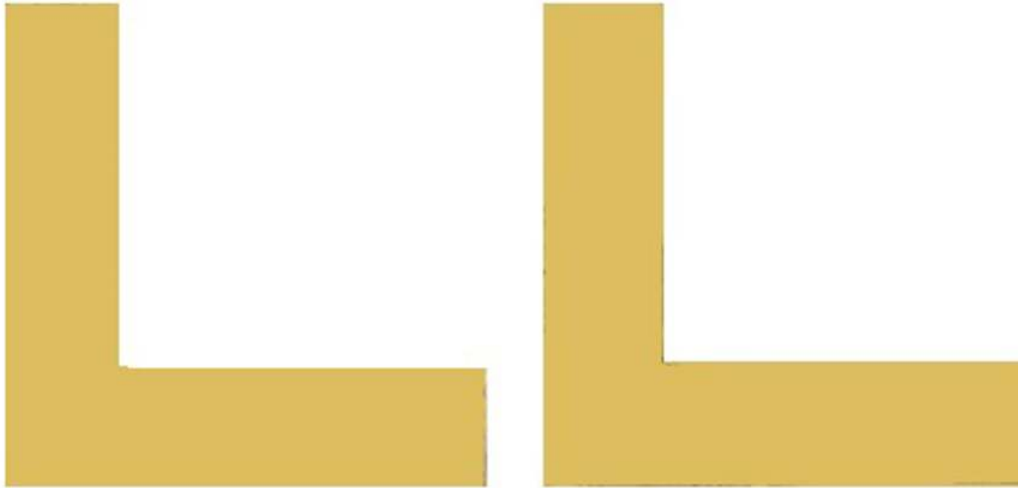
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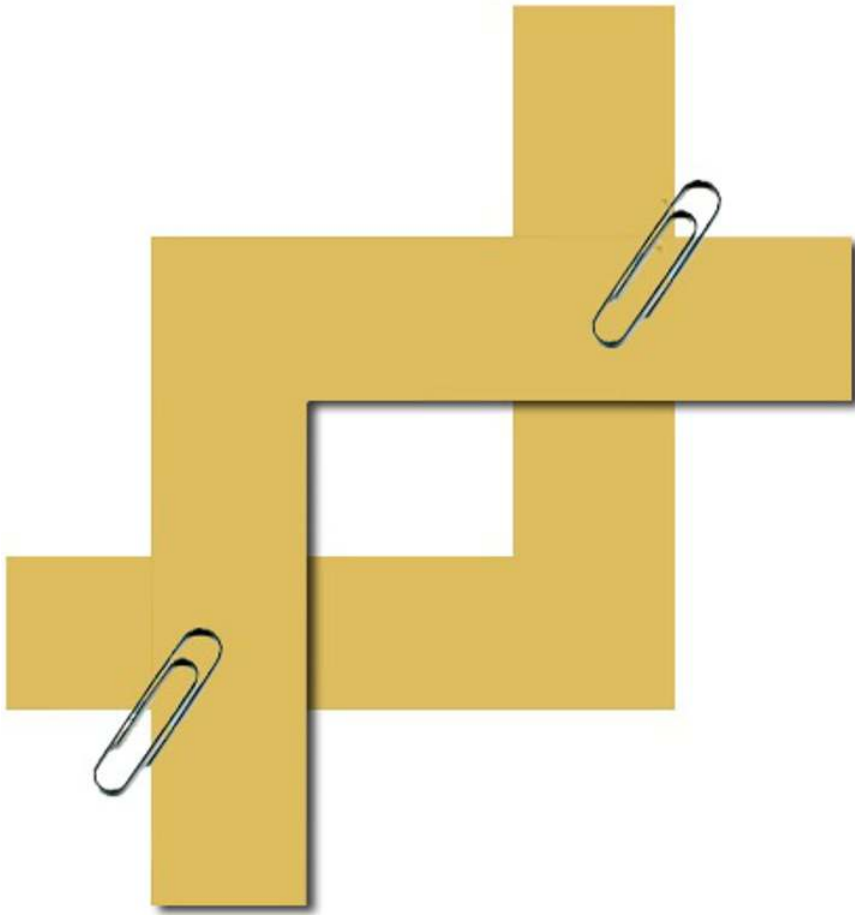
1.5: Instructions for Making a Viewer

Introduction

A viewer can help you evaluate your composition. Use a solid color card stock or stiff paper (standard 8 1/2 x 11 inch paper is OK). Avoid prints or patterns on your card stock. To create the viewer:

1. Cut two identical L shapes.
2. Arrange your L shapes so there is a rectangular window to view your composition through.
3. Attach your L shapes together with a paperclip so the window size can easily be adjusted. The size of the viewer window will change depending on the size of your composition so don't use tape to attach your L shapes.





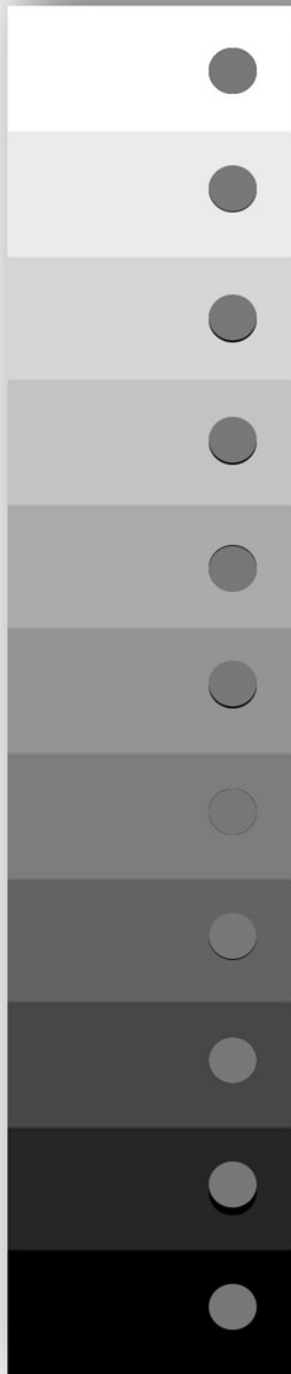
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1.6: Eleven Step Gray Scale

Introduction

Your instructor will provide an 11 step gray scale punched with holes to be used during the semester as your value scanner. The scanner is placed on top of an assignment when it is dry to determine the value of a color. This requires practice. Note: The seventh hole down in the image below seems to disappear because it is the same value as the background.

Store your value scanner in the pocket made in class inside the back cover of your sketchbook.



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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Sketchbook Assignments

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[2.2: Chromatic Grayscale](#)

[2.3: Three Color Wheels](#)

[2.4: Personal Color Preferences](#)

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2.1: Achromatic Value Scales

Preparing Your Paper

1. Paint two 11 x 2 inch strips per page in your sketchbook. Make sure to leave room next to each strip for written descriptions.
2. Title your two pages Achromatic Value Scales.
3. Write the pigments you used next to each gray scale. Use your micron pen and if you need to sketch letters first, use your non-photo blue pencil. Make sure letters are consistent and neat.
4. Check values with your value scanner when completely dry.

Materials:

- ½ “ flat brush
- Colors: black, white, ultramarine blue, burnt umber, alizarine crimson, thalo green
- Mixing palette
- Palette knife
- Water & container
- Masking tape
- 9” x 12” mixed media sketchbook
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Ruler

Page 1, left side: Painting and Mixing

1. Paint a vertical [11- step gray scale](#), black at the bottom, white at the top.
2. Measure 1/2 inch at the top and bottom of your page, then use a ruler to draw a 2 x 11 inch strip.
3. Measure one inch increments from the bottom of the strip until you reach the top.
4. Make 1 inch measurement marks on either side of the strip and draw a line with your ruler.
5. Tape the outer edge of your strip to keep paint from getting in the margin of your paper.
6. Mix and paint each value to match the gray scale value scanner distributed in class.

Page 1, right side: Blending and Value Painting

1. Measure 1/2 inch at the top and bottom of your page, then use a ruler to draw a 2 x 11 inch strip.
2. Tape off outer edges as in the previous exercise.
3. Practice blending using your largest flat brush. Use a small amount of gloss medium to increase the flow of your paint.
4. Put a small amount of black n your mixing palette.
5. Make a large pile of white in a clean area far from the black.
6. Mix a separate pile of middle gray (value scale step 6) on your palette using part of the black and white paint piles. Do not pollute your main paint piles with remnants of paint on your palette knife. Use your baby wipes to keep it clean.
7. Start the strip with a clean brush and black at the bottom, your middle gray in the middle and white at the top. You will need to keep wiping your large blending brush with baby wipes to keep it from messing up your blend. Work quickly to blend your values smoothly, creating a smooth 11-step gradient with no breaks.

Page 2: Mixing Color to Make Black.

1. Measure 1/2 inch at the top and bottom of your page, then use a ruler to draw two more 2 x 11 inch strips, as in the previous exercises. Tape off the edges.
2. Paint your first gray scale on the left, using burnt umber and ultramarine blue.
3. Paint your second gray scale on the right, using alizarine crimson and pthalo green.

Mixed Black / Gray Tips:

- Mix burnt umber and ultramarine blue until it appears to be black.
- Start with the brown and gradually add the blue until your paint pile that appears to be black.
- Scrape off a small amount of the paint with your palette knife and gradually add a little white.
- If it appears to be blue or brown, the balance between the two colors is not correct.
- Continue testing the larger dark pile until it appears gray in the small sample. Do not pollute the large white or mixed black pile on your palette. Create a large middle gray pile.

- You will have three piles of paint: mixed black, mixed middle gray and white.
- Mix gradations on other areas of the palette - this is why you need a large palette.
- Follow the same procedure for mixing pthalo green and alizarine crimson.

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2.2: Chromatic Grayscale

Examples

See samples of Chromatic Grays in the Glossary ([p. 156](#)) of the *Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers* (Hornung, 2012).

Guidelines:

- Title your two pages Chromatic Grayscales.
- Write the pigments used next to each strip.
- The first strip will have 11 steps as in the achromatic grayscale assignment. This one needs to match your value scanner exactly.
- The other three strips are blended, as smoothly as possible, with all the values on the scanner.
- You do not need to write the value numbers next to the chromatic grayscales.
- Tip: Get a fine spray bottle to keep your blends from drying too fast.

Sketchbook Pages 3 and 4:

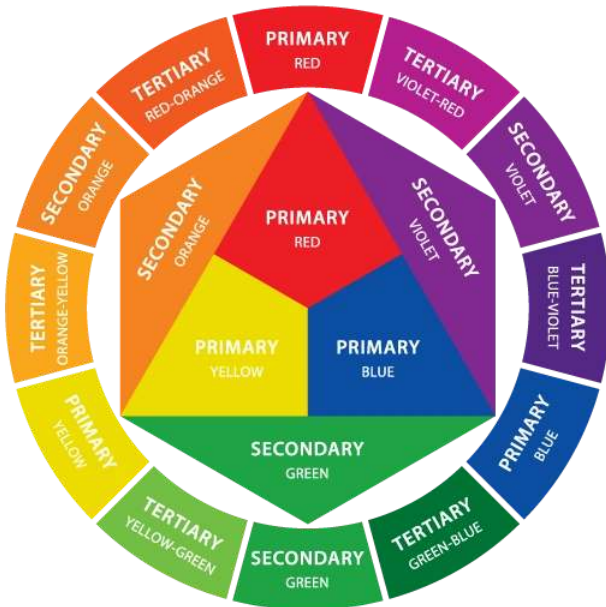
1. Measure 1/2 inch from the top and bottom of your page.
2. Draw two 11 x 2 inch strips per page.
3. Allow a slight amount of color to be visible, while maintaining a gray appearance.
4. Strip 1: Mix phthalo blue, burnt sienna (11 steps).
5. Strip 2: Mix cadmium yellow, ultramarine blue, cadmium red (blended).
6. Strip 3: Mix cadmium yellow, phthalo blue, alizarine crimson (blended).
7. Strip 4: Mix cadmium red, yellow ochre, ultramarine blue (blended).

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2.3: Three Color Wheels

Guidelines:

- Draw one color wheel, using your non-photo blue pencil on each sketchbook page.
- Draw lightly!
- Do not work on both sides of your pages!
- Blow dry to make sure the paint is dry before going to the next page.
- List the pigments used for each color using your micron pen.
- Indicate which colors are primary, secondary, tertiary.
- You may use the design scheme below for your color wheels or design your own.



Create Your Three Color Wheels

Color combinations for each composition are listed below. **Do not use white to lighten.**

1. Create Color Wheel #1 limiting your colors to:
 - cadmium red
 - cadmium yellow
 - ultramarine blue
2. Create Color Wheel #2 limiting your colors to:
 - cadmium red
 - cadmium yellow
 - thalo blue
3. Create Color Wheel #3 using the following colors:
 1. Alizarine crimson
 2. cadmium red
 3. cadmium yellow
 4. ultramarine blue
 5. thalo blue

Mixing tips:

- Primary red = cadmium red
- Primary blue = ultramarine + small touch of thalo blue
- Primary yellow = cadmium yellow
- Alizarine crimson + ultramarine blue = purple
- Cadmium red + cadmium yellow = orange
- Cadmium yellow + thalo blue = green - do not use thalo green

Color Wheel image from [Colour Theory](#) on Aesthetics Wiki. CC-BY-SA

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2.4: Personal Color Preferences

Materials:

- Your 9" x 12" sketchbook
- Gehrhardt Richter Color Chart
- Micron pen – for page label
- Ruler
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Eraser
- Color test paper for color experiments
- Spray bottle to keep palette moist.
- All paint supplies – Use all required colors except no black

Grid Procedure:

You will have a ½ inch margin at all edges of your paper except the top, which is 1 ½ inches. Then mark eight - 1 inch rows across and ten - 1 inch rows down with your non-photo blue pencil.

1. Draw a 1 ½ inch margin at the top of your 9 x 12 inch page. Then draw ½ inch margins on sides and bottom.
2. Measure from the tear off point of the page, do not include the spiral. This results in a 8 x 10 inch work area.
3. Mark the long sides (left side, right side) of the work area into ten 1 inch parts.
4. Mark the short sides (top and bottom) of your work area into eight 1 inch parts.
5. Draw grid lines, making sure the lines are straight, side to side, top to bottom.
6. You now have eighty 1 inch squares.

Guidelines:

- Select at least 80 color samples that you like from the [Gerhardt Richter Color Chart](#). Think about the colors you like to wear and the colors you choose for your environment. Are there colors you can't live without?
- Choose a wide variety of values from light to dark.
- Do not duplicate any color.
- Paint each square neatly and without streaks.
- Make sure each painted sample touches the edges of the surrounding squares in a clean precise manner.
- Matching a color may require mixing colors you have not used before; therefore, you need test paper to get the correct color before you paint it in your sketchbook. Do not do this without a full palette layout. Experiment with all the required colors.
- Label your page in the top margin: Personal Color Preferences.
- Make sure there is no pencil showing in the final project.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Color Theory Tree Compositions

- 3.1: Tree Image
- 3.2: Complementary Color Assignment
- 3.3: Warm/Cool Assignment
- 3.4: Triad Color Assignment
- 3.5: Muted Color Assignment
- 3.6: Tints and Shades Assignment

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3.1: Tree Image





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3.2: Complementary Color Assignment

Materials:

- Trim your 14 inch wide Bristol Board to 12 inches wide before cutting in half to make two 8½ x 12 inch compositions
- Tape
- Board
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Ruler
- Painting supplies
- White and complementary colors, 1 set for each composition
- Tree photo
- Viewer

Guidelines

1. Tape your two compositions to your board using your tape to make clean ¼inch margins around each composition.
2. Measure and draw the width of your margins to make them straight.
3. Choose two sets of complementary colors, one set for each composition.
4. Make sure there is one mixed secondary color and one primary color on your palette plus a large amount of white.
5. Background: Mix one set of complements together to make a chromatic gray, then add a small amount of the mixture to a large pile of white. Mix a little lighter than #2 on your scanner. It will dry darker. Paint the entire surface of one of your compositions using your largest brush.
6. Repeat background process with a different set of complements. Both compositions will be a light chromatic gray background.
7. After the surfaces are completely dry, draw a contour drawing of a zoomed in view of tree branches with intricate spaces. Each composition should be different!
8. Complementary colors are opposite each other on the color wheel: The three main complementary sets are Red & Green, Blue & Orange or Yellow & Violet.
9. You may add white to lighten the colors, but no black. You can darken or dull colors by mixing with complements.
10. Both compositions must contain:
 - a. A full range of value from light to dark. Use the value scanner (value strip with holes punched) to match value to color to make sure you have some of each value.
 - b. Variety in mixtures of the two complements and their tints (made by adding white). Try varying the percentage of each color to move the colors to warm or cool ranges.
11. No pure unmixed color! Very little complement in a color = higher saturation (brightness). If complements are balanced, they become less saturated (dull).
12. Write your name and the complementary colors you used on the back of each composition.
13. Remove tape when dry. If your paper tears, use your glue stick to repair by gluing the torn section back to the surface.

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3.3: Warm/Cool Assignment

Introduction

Read [p. 22 in *Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers*](#) (Hornung, 2012). You will be creating two more tree compositions as in the previous tree assignment.

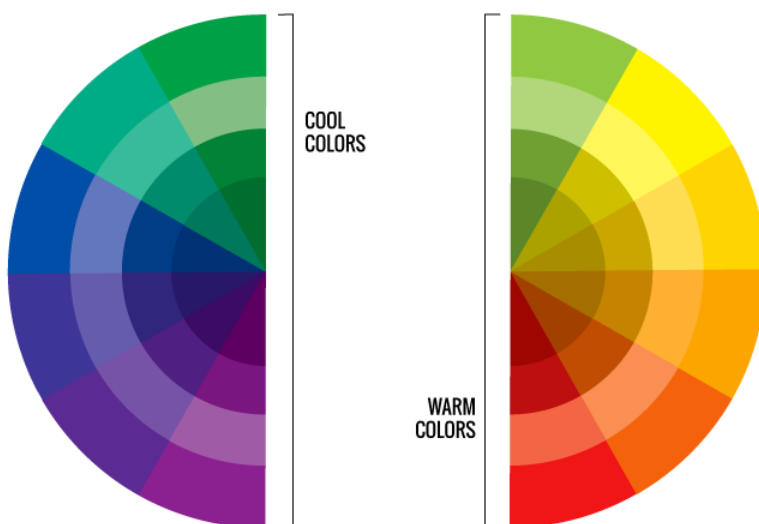
Materials

- 14 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet, trimmed to 12 inches wide, then cut in half for two 8½ x 12 inch compositions
- Tape
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Make separate palettes for each composition
- Your palette contain should contain six warm colors & six cool colors plus white to lighten

Guidelines

1. Draw a contour drawing of a zoomed in view of tree branches with intricate spaces. Select warm colors from the colors you used for your third color wheel in the sketchbook. Warm colors are yellow, yellow orange, orange, red orange, red and reddish purple.
2. Use a different view of the zoomed in branches to create a second composition on the other half of your paper. Select cool colors from the colors you used for your third color wheel in the sketchbook. Cool colors are yellow green, green, yellow blue, blue, bluish purple and purple.
3. Both compositions must contain:
 - a. A full range of value from light to dark. Use the value scanner (value strip with holes punched) to match value to color to make sure you have some of each value.
 - b. Variety in mixtures of your selected colors.

WARM & COOL COLORS



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3.4: Triad Color Assignment

Materials

- One half 12 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet, taped edges to board – trim your 14 inch wide paper to 12 inches wide before cutting in half. You will have two 8½ x 12 inch compositions
- Tape
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Earth tone primary colors: yellow ochre, burnt sienna, Payne's gray (black + small amount of ultramarine blue)
- Primary triad colors: cadmium yellow, cadmium red, ultramarine blue
- White to lighten

Guidelines

1. Read about earth-tone primary colors on [page 17, fig1.11 in *Color : A workshop for artists and designers*](#) (Hornung, 2012).
2. Draw a contour drawing of a zoomed in view of tree branches with intricate spaces.
 - a. Choose the earth-tone primary triad found on page 17, fig1.11: yellow ochre, burnt sienna and Payne's gray. (Mix Payne's gray by adding a slight amount of ultramarine blue to black). You may add white to lighten the colors.
 - b. Experiment with getting as many colors as you can out of the three limited earth tones.
 - c. Colors may be stand alone or mixed from the three main colors. You will not have a large amount of blue, only a small amount in the Payne's gray mixture.
3. Use a different view of the zoomed in branches to create a second composition on the other half of your paper.
 - a. This time, use the primary triad: cadmium red, cadmium yellow, and ultramarine blue.
 - b. **Colors may not be mixed with each other this time, only white to lighten.**
 - c. Your darkest colors will be the pure hue of the primary color.
4. Both compositions must contain:
 - a. The fullest value range possible given the color limitations.
 - b. Use the value scanner (value strip with holes punched) to match value to color to make sure you have variety in value.
 - c. Interesting compositions, variety in branch placements and sizes.
 - d. Effective color interactions.

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3.5: Muted Color Assignment

Introduction

This assignment is based on the two assignments on [p. 52 of *Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers*](#) (Hornung, 2012).

Materials

- One half 12 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet. Trim your 14 inch wide paper to 12 inches wide before cutting in half. You will have two 8½ x 12 inch compositions
- Tape
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Value scanner

Guidelines

- Tape your sheet to your board, ¼ inch clean, even margins!
 - Use a minimum of a broad nine muted colors. (Colors that fall between chromatic grays and prismatic colors in the saturation continuum).
 - Create your nine muted colors on the upper portion of a sketchbook page before beginning the project. Label these Muted Colors.
 - Hue ranges must be broad or varied.
 - You may use white to lighten.
 - Use the same muted colors in each composition.
 - You may change the position of the muted colors in each composition, as in [Figs. 4.12 & 4.13, p. 52](#).
 - Use no color more than once.
1. Draw a contour drawing of a zoomed in view of tree branches with intricate spaces. Use your nine muted colors to achieve a broad value range from light to dark. Use the value scanner (value strip with holes punched) to match value to color to make sure you have a wide variety in value in your first composition. See [Fig.4.12, p. 52](#).
 2. Use a different view of the zoomed in branches to create a second composition on the other half of your paper. This time, use your nine muted colors to create a close value range. Colors must be numbers 3 or 4 on your value scale. See [fig. 4.13, p. 52](#).
 3. Both compositions must contain:
 - a. The assigned value range for each composition.
 - b. Interesting compositions, variety in branch placements and sizes.
 - c. Exaggerated differences in branch sizes.
 - d. Overlapping branches.
 - e. Effective color interactions.
 - f. Clean, even, ¼ Inch margins.

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3.6: Tints and Shades Assignment

Materials

- One half 12 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet. Trim your 14 inch wide paper to 12 inches wide before cutting in half. You will have two 8½ x 12 inch compositions
- Tape your sheet to your board, ¼ inch clean, even margins!
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Value scanner

Guidelines

- Paint your nine main high saturation colors on the second half of page five in your sketchbook. This is the color reference for your two tree compositions. Do this first!
 - Use a broad selection of nine high saturation colors (pure hues such as orange, yellow, yellow green, red, blue, blue violet, etc.
 - Value ranges for the nine main colors must be between 5 and 10 – vary the value ranges of your main colors.
 - Use white to lighten.
 - Use black to darken.
 - Use the same main colors in each composition.
 - You may change the position of the nine colors in each composition.
 - Use no color more than once in each composition.
1. Shades: Draw a contour drawing of a zoomed in view of tree branches with intricate spaces. Use your nine high saturation colors to achieve a narrow, dark, low key value range by adding black to create shades of your main colors. Use the value scanner (value strip with holes punched) to match value to color. Values will be low key, ranging from **7 to 11** on your value scanner – vary your values!
 2. Tints: Use a different view of the zoomed in branches to create a second composition on the other half of your paper. This time, use your nine high saturation colors to create a high key, close value range by adding white to make tints of your main colors. Colors must be numbers **1 to 4** on your value scanner – vary your values!
 3. Both compositions must contain:
 - a. Assigned value range for each composition.
 - b. Interesting compositions, variety in branch placements and sizes.
 - c. Exaggerated differences in branch sizes.
 - d. Overlapping branches.
 - e. Effective color interactions.
 - f. Clean, even, ¼ Inch margins.

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Color Theory Projects

- 4.1: Simultaneous Contrast Assignment
- 4.2: Midterm Project
- 4.3: Repeating Shapes Project
- 4.4: Transparency and Space Assignment
- 4.5: Final Project
- 4.6: Final Presentation

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4.1: Simultaneous Contrast Assignment

Introduction

The rule of simultaneous contrast states that any color can appear to vary depending on the color placed next to it, suggesting that the color similarities are cancelled as the dissimilarities are emphasized. This is evident in the [example on p. 62](#) where circles contain the same color but each seems different. (*Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers*, Hornung, 2012).

You will set up a grid of two-inch squares in your 12 x 16 inch work space (six equal columns at the top, eight equal rows on the sides) filled with a repeating image.

Design a number from 2 to 9 that will break the cell into shapes that will be used for the placement of colors to see how they affect each other.

Materials

- Brushes, palette, water container, paper towels, baby wipes
- All required colors
- Glazing fluid
- 14 x 17 inch Bristol board
- Masking tape
- Value scanner
- Acrylic paint (all colors)
- X-acto knife
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Ruler
- Card stock or Bristol board scraps for template

Guidelines

1. Tape ½ inch margins top and bottom and 1 inch margins on the sides to create a 12 x 16 inch work area.
2. Use one constant, low-intensity (dull) color near middle-gray, no darker than #4 on your corrected value scanner for your number color.
3. Paint the entire sheet the dull middle gray color that will become your number.
4. Draw your grid on the dry painted sheet with a non-photo blue pencil.
5. Draw and cut out a template with your X-acto knife on a piece of card stock or Bristol board, to serve as a guide for your number inside the rectangles.
6. Measure the template to fit the rectangles exactly.
7. Do not let the numbers touch the edges of the rectangles.
8. Fill in the negative spaces of the rectangles with new colors that contrast with the low-intensity constant.
9. Lay out all required colors for the class before starting your mixtures.
10. Squeeze out a larger amount of white than the other colors.
11. No straight out of the tube color.
12. No colors may be repeated.
13. Use a variety of mixed colors that vary in level of intensity and value.
14. Use a variety of warm and cool colors.
15. Paint a range of light, medium, and dark colors.
16. Use as many new, contrasting colors as you can.
17. The goal is to change the appearance of the constant color by the new colors you put next to it depicting simultaneous contrast.

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4.2: Midterm Project

Materials

- Newspaper or magazine color photos
- X-acto knife for trimming photos
- Glue stick for mounting
- Sketchbook
- 14 x 17 inch Bristol board
- 1 sheet (16 x 20 inch, cut to 16 x 19 inches) Canson Presentation Board, pearl (tan) color
- non-photo blue pencil
- Ruler
- Masking tape
- All required colors and paint supplies – you will set up a full palette for the project

Guidelines

1. Preliminary studies for mounted midterm project in your sketchbook:
 - a. Three cropped photos, enlarged so that objects are not easily recognized – no whole objects!
 - b. Choose photo sections with a variety of color and value.
 - c. Use your viewer to crop photo to the same shape proportions as your 14 x 17 inch Bristol board.
2. Glue the three cropped photos in a vertical row, leaving space under each one for your color swatches.
3. Paint color swatches matching the colors of your photo directly under each proposed composition. Find as many colors as you can.
4. Choose one of your three cropped photos for midterm project (instructor approval required). Draw a cross in the center of your image to assist in scaling up to a full sheet size. See Photo Project samples on Canvas.
5. Tape a clean, even ¼ inch margin on all four sides. This must stay clean for mounting. It will not be cut off.
6. Draw a cross in the center of your full sheet of Bristol board to divide your drawing into four parts for easier scaling. This will correspond to the cross in your image, so attention to correct proportion of your cropped image is essential.
7. Draw the basic shapes of your image one quarter of the image at a time. It is easier to establish correct proportion by measuring where the placement of objects are on your page in relationship to the edges of your four grid marks. This is a contour line drawing, no shading, since it will be painted.
8. Match your colors exactly as possible to the newspaper image colors.
9. Painting must be clean with no paper showing.
10. Allow painting to dry overnight before mounting cleanly on your 16 x 20 inch presentation board. Cut your board to 19 inches before mounting to make a one inch even border around your project. Glue securely, no lifting edges.

Four Painting Stages

1. **Drawing:** Simplify for underpainting.



2. **Underpainting:** Simplify color and shapes. Make sure there is no paper showing.



3. **Second Layer:** Add more detail.



4. **Final Painting:** All details added.



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4.3: Repeating Shapes Project

Materials

- One 14 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet
- Tape your sheet to your board, ¼ inch clean, even margins!
- Pencil for sketchbook
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Value scanner

Guidelines

- Use a repeated shape in a variety of sizes to create a composition derived from one of three choices:
 - A shape used by a professional artist.
 - A unique symbol that symbolizes your self – shape only, not a letter.
 - A shape derived from an object found outdoors.
- Sketchbook:
 - Draw three ideas for your shape using pencil.
 - Draw 2 preliminary compositions after choosing your shape (small thumbnails).
 - Practice a variety of approaches to painting line for the project – try different colors.
 - Paint nine color swatches under the shape drawings that you will use in your shape project.
- Colors:
 - Primary Triad (cadmium red, cadmium yellow, and ultramarine blue)
 - White to lighten
 - Black to darken
 - Experimental color mixtures – use a wide variety of colors.
 - Values present: 2, 4 6, 8. - use your value scanner to determine value of color

Composition Must Contain

- The assigned value range for the composition.
- Shapes may vary in the way they are drawn, so long as they echo the primary shape choice.
- Interesting compositions, variety in shape placements and sizes.
- Variety in shape directions.
- Variety in value – do not repeat one type of value too many times.
- Exaggerated differences in shape sizes.
- Overlapping shapes.
- Effective color interactions.
- Shapes with line.
- Shapes without line.
- Clean, even, ¼ inch margins

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4.4: Transparency and Space Assignment

Materials

- One 14 x 17 inch Bristol board sheet
- Tape your sheet to your board, ¼ inch clean, even margins!
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Painting supplies
- Value scanner

Guidelines

Sketchbook:

- Paint nine muted color swatches plus one high saturation accent color swatch in your sketchbook. This is the color reference for your composition. Do this first!
- Paint four crosses, two median transparency, two dark transparency using your transparency project colors. See [page 84 & view sample fig. 6.28](#) (*Color: A workshop for artists and designers*, Hornung, 2012)
- Draw three proposed compositions using your chosen shape on the same page as your color swatches. Shapes may be rectangles & squares, a shape you used for your shapes project, or a new shape – keep them simple!

Project:

- Value ranges for your composition: 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6.
- Shapes fill the page. There is no background.
- A total of ten shapes based on a single shape.
- Six of your shapes must overlap other shapes.
- Vary shape sizes and placements.
- Median transparency – hue and value of overlapping area is halfway between the two parent colors.
- Dark transparency – value of the overlapping area is darker than both parent colors.

Composition Must Contain

- Assigned value ranges.
- Interesting compositions, variety in shape placements and sizes.
- Exaggerated differences in shape sizes.
- Overlapping shapes.
- Use of median and dark transparency.
- Use of scale and overlapping shapes to create the illusion of space.
- Effective color interactions.
- Clean, even, ¼ inch margins.

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4.5: Final Project

Materials

- Quality color photo of a fine art painting, museum artists only
- Value scanner
- Glue stick for mounting
- Sketchbook
- One sheet 14 x 17 inch Bristol board
- One sheet (16 x 20 inch) Canson Presentation Board, pearl color (greyish tan)
- Cut mounting board to 16 x 19 inch for even margins.
- Non-photo blue pencil
- Ruler
- Masking Tape
- All required colors and paint supplies – you will set up a full palette for the project

Sketchbook

- You must complete the preliminary studies in the sketchbook pages sketchbook before beginning your final project.
- Glue your selected fine art color sample at the top of the page. Write information under the image: Artist, title, medium.
- Choose nine main colors from your color sample source that have wide value range, 1 or 2 through 10 or 11.
- Paint nine small color swatches of your selected colors directly under your painting source if painting is horizontal, or to the side if painting is vertical.
- Draw a rectangle directly under the swatches and paint a proportional color inventory of your painting source, as on [page 113](#), [figs 8.5 & 8.6](#). (*Color: A workshop for artists and designers*, Hornung, 2012)
- Your design must use the same proportion and values of chosen colors as in the fine art source.
- Research intricate textile designs – see samples in our Canvas course and research additional images on your own. You will get extra credit for gluing photos of your own textile research in your sketchbook.
- Sketch at least nine different shapes that might be part of your final design on a separate page.
- Write notes about the type of textile you are creating. Is it for children, adults, home furnishings, personal wear, or other uses?
- Draw two thumbnail sketch proposals for your complex textile design, which must include a variety of shapes and repetitions of the shapes. Parts of the design may go off the format edges, as in viewed complex textile samples on Canvas.

Guidelines

- The focus is on professional craftsmanship, color matching, and creative textile design.
- This is an in-class only project – no take-home unless specified!
- Tape a clean, even ¼ inch margin on all four sides. This must stay clean for mounting.
- Your textile design must contain nine colors in the same proportion and value as the fine art source.
- The design must be intricate and complex, using a variety of shapes, values and techniques to create a repetitive motif.
- Painting must be clean, no paper showing.
- Shapes may refer to subject matter of your choice or may be completely abstract.
- Your design may be for any type of textile, pillows, couches, rugs, pajamas, clothing of all types.
- You may choose your own style and approach to the project.
- Dry artwork completely before mounting on your 16 x 19 inch presentation board. Glue securely, no lifting edges. This requires a lot of glue stick! Press glue stick firmly around backside edges, then make several X's in the center that extend to the edges. Align on mounting board and press firmly with a clean sheet of paper, rubbing your hand on the surface to burnish the image firmly to the mounting board.

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4.6: Final Presentation

Guidelines

- Discuss the percentage accuracy of your proportional inventory.
 - Did you achieve the artwork color, complete value range and proportions of color in your final project?
 - What is the audience for your textile and what types of objects could use your design?
 - What do you like best about your design?
-

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Color Theory Essays and Checklists

[5.1: Final Exam Essay](#)

[5.2: Sketch Book Organization Requirements](#)

[5.3: Final Portfolio Organization](#)

[5.4: Extra Credit Essay](#)

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5.1: Final Exam Essay

Introduction

Write in your own words, do not copy and paste the text (this is plagiarism). Each question is worth 20 points for 100 points total.

Submitting Your Essay

Submit your essay in the Final Essay Assignment in Canvas. It must be in one of the following file formats: .doc, .docx, .rtf, Google doc, or .pdf.

Guidelines

- Include the number of the question you're answering before your essay answer. Pay attention to what the question is asking. There may be more than one part to each question.
- Answer each question section in paragraph format, one paragraph for each question, minimum.
- Use complete sentences and correct grammar.
- Go into detail in your writing. Do not over-simplify your answers.
- Write clearly and cleanly for best results.

Questions

Research chapters 5, 6, 7, and 8 in *Color: A workshop for artists and designers* (Hornung, 2012).

1. Describe the principal of optical mixing and discuss the types of images that use this process.
2. Discuss one major artist who uses optical mixing.
 - a. Give the artist's name, title of the work, medium and date.
 - b. Describe how the optical mixing process is used in the artist's work.
3. Who is Josef Albers?
 - a. What did he contribute to color theory?
 - b. Describe one of one of his classic experiments.
 - c. Give one of Josef Albers' quotes.
4. Discuss the differences between median and dark transparency. Describe how you achieved the two types of transparency in your own [Transparency and Space](#) project.
5. What are the factors that influence color harmony?
 - a. Discuss ways in which hue, value and saturation can contribute to or disrupt color harmony.
 - b. In which cases are bridge tones helpful?
6. Describe two approaches to color inventory. Discuss reasons an artist might want to create color inventories.

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5.2: Sketch Book Organization Requirements

Part One

Note: Do not work on both sides of your pages.

Pages 1 and 2

- **Page titles:** Achromatic Grayscales
- Two grayscales per page
- Write colors used under each grayscale
 - Black and white 11 step gray scale - list actual values next to each step using your value scanner.
 - Black and white blended gray scale - as many values as possible.
 - Ultramarine blue & burnt umber - 11 step grayscale - match values to scanner, list actual values.
 - Phthalo green & alizarine crimson - 11 step grayscale - match values to scanner, list actual values.

Pages 3 and 4

- **Page titles:** Chromatic Grayscales
- Allow a slight amount of color to be visible, while maintaining a gray appearance.
- 2 grayscales per page
- Write colors used under each grayscale. See chromatic gray samples on [p. 156 of *Color: A workshop for artists and designers*](#). (Hornung, 2012).
 - Phthalo blue, burnt sienna - 11 step grayscale - this one needs to be accurate with the value scanner!
 - Cadmium yellow, ultramarine blue, cadmium red - blended grayscale, as many values as possible.
 - Cadmium yellow, phthalo blue, alizarine crimson - blended grayscale, as many values as possible.
 - Cadmium red, yellow ochre, ultramarine blue - blended grayscale, as many values as possible.

Pages 5, 6, and 7

- **Page titles:** Color Wheels
- Three color wheels, one per page
- Indicate which colors are primary, secondary, tertiary colors in each wheel.
- Write the colors used to paint each of the primary and secondary swatches.
 - Cadmium red, cadmium yellow, ultramarine blue
 - Cadmium red, cadmium yellow, phthalo blue
 - Cadmium red, alizarine crimson, cadmium yellow, ultramarine blue, thalo blue

Part Two

If you made up any assignments from the first part of your sketchbook, you must include your graded checklist.

Personal Color Preference Swatches

- Refer to [Gerhard Richter, 192 Colors](#)
- Choose 80 colors you like. They must be included in the Richter painting

Preliminary Studies for Mounted Midterm Project

- Three cropped photos, enlarged so that objects are not easily recognized – no whole objects! Color swatches matching the colors of your photo to the right of each one.
- 1st half of page:
 - Color swatches for your nine muted colors
 - Title: Muted Colors.
- 2nd half of page:
 - Paint nine main high saturation colors on ½ page in your sketchbook as a color reference for your two tints and shades compositions.
 - Value ranges for the nine main base colors must be between 5 and 10 - vary this as much as possible.

- Title: High Saturation Colors.

Part Three

If you made up any assignments from the first or second part of your sketchbook, you must notify me of improved projects with your prior grade sheets.

Repeating Shapes Homework

- Two or more design drawing proposals
- Nine project color swatches

Transparency and Space Homework

- Three thumbnail composition sketches in pencil, and nine color swatches.
- Four crosses, two median transparency, two dark transparency using your Transparency project colors.

Textile Project (Final Project) Homework

- Fine art source labeled with artist, title, and medium.
- Nine painted color swatches based on the fine art source.
- Proportional color map based on the fine art source.
- Sketches of nine or more shapes that might be part of your final textile.
- Two thumbnail sketch proposals for a complex textile.
- Notes on the proposed purpose(s) of your textile

Textile Research

- Photos of your own additional textile research (extra credit).

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5.3: Final Portfolio Organization

Portfolio Order

Make sure your name and assignment title is written on the back of each piece.

Arrange with trees on top in order of assignment, as below, then Numbers, Shapes, Transparency, Midterm and Final at the back.

Any extra experiments or work not in the sketchbook.

1. All 10 tree compositions:
 - a. 2 Complements
 - b. 1 Warm / 1 Cool
 - c. 2 Triads
 - d. 2 Muted
 - e. 1 Tints / 1 Shades
2. Number Project
3. Repeating Shapes Project
4. Transparency & Space Project
5. Mounted Midterm Project
6. Mounted Final Project
7. First day brush exercise
8. Extra color experiments or work outside the sketchbook

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5.4: Extra Credit Essay

Formatting Guidelines

Use the following formatting guidelines to write an extra credit essay

- Your finished essay should be no shorter than 2 single-spaced typewritten pages, or three double-spaced typewritten pages.
- Use correct grammar and complete sentences.
- Use your own words, no copying/pasting (plagiarism).
- Acceptable file formats: .doc, .docx, .rtf, .pdf, Google doc
- Submit to Extra Credit Essay Assignment in Canvas by the due date.
- This assignment can replace one low writing assignment grade or add 1-2% percent to your total grade average. This will only help your total grade if your average is 59, 69, 79 or 89 percent. Example: 89% (B) will increase to 90% (A).

Expository Writing Format

1. **Introduction:** Introduce the idea you are talking about in a thesis statement and supporting paragraph.
2. **Body:** Discuss the various aspects of your thesis. Include any research and materials that support the idea.
3. **Conclusion:** Recapitulate the original idea and its supporting material briefly, together with any conclusions you have about the results of your research.

Assignment Guidelines

Review one work of colorful fine art. Make sure your essay includes:

1. Your name, the course, and the title of the assignment (see the [library's guide to MLA Style](#)).
2. The gallery or museum you visited, or at least three sources on the same work of art from a text, if you are unable to attend an exhibit (to be included at the end of the paper on a Works cited sheet).
3. The name of the artist.
4. The title of the piece.
5. The medium used.
6. The size (estimate if the information is not available to you).
7. Include biographical information on the artist, and the period in which the work occurs within the artist's career.
8. Discuss the function of color in the work of art. Describe the colors used with regard to their hues, values, saturations.
9. When discussing the work of art, consider its formal elements and its composition. Refer to the design principles outlined in the next section.

Design Principles

- **Harmony (Unity):** Agreement among the art elements (line, color, space, light, volume, value, texture, time and motion).
- **Variety:** Difference, provides interest or contrast to sameness Variety is achieved by changing aspects of an element (ex. same shape, different size or value), hold one or two elements constant & change others (ex. all round shapes, but different values or colors), transition of one element into another (ex. dark grades into light, smooth texture changes into rough) and contrast two different elements juxtaposed so we compare difference (ex. strong dark next to strong light).
- **Unity:** Achieved by repetition (of kind of line, shapes, etc.), proximity or grouping of forms, continuation of contour or edge from form to form, and careful placement so the eye connects parts (ex. triangular composition).
- **Balance:** Visual scale of weights, it is felt optically. Consider the position and placement of information on the picture plane as well as the size and proportion.
- **Movement/Rhythm:** It is implied by placement, directional lines, contour edges. Indicates the path the viewer's eye must travel though the picture plane, a sense of visual cadence is developed.
- **Economy:** Use only what works to support the whole, the less complicated the more successful the composition. "Less is More!"

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Works Cited

Hornung, David. *Color: A Workshop for Artists and Designers*. 2nd ed. London: Lawrence King, 2012.

Richter, Gerhard. *192 Colors*. 1966, Hamburger Kunsthalle, Hamburg, Germany, (loan from private collection).

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